

by December 2017. The third halving took place in May 2020, and the price of Bitcoin rose from \$9,734 to \$68,789 by November 2021, reaching its peak one year and six months after the halving, explains Ryan Lee, Chief Analyst at Bitget Research, which looks at cryptocurrencies.

“The fourth halving will occur in April 2024. It is expected that the price of Bitcoin will rise and peak one year and five months after the halving. A similar trend has been observed with the previous three halvings, with prices increasing over time to hit a new all-time high,” says Lee. “There are approximately 60 days until the Bitcoin halving in April 2024, which could potentially push the cryptocurrency market to new highs,” says Shivram Thakral, CEO of digital asset exchange BuyUcoin.

The Bitcoin price has surged 3.8 times since the beginning of 2023, indicating sustained growth this

time around. Standard Chartered Bank has predicted that the Bitcoin price could reach \$120,000 by the end of 2024.

Post February 1, 2022, trading volumes on crypto exchanges in India had plunged by more than 90% due to the introduction in the Union Budget of a flat 30% tax on profits from crypto and 1% TDS (tax deducted at source) on sell transactions. Indian crypto exchange founders have been fighting for survival for the past couple of years. They embraced varied strategies. These include exploring alternative revenue sources, implementing workforce reductions, and cutting marketing expenditures. Some have diversified their businesses, while others have migrated to more crypto-friendly locations.

However, the US Securities and Exchange Commission’s (SEC) approval of the first Bitcoin ETF in the US has boosted crypto worldwide

and increased demand for the oldest virtual currency. Bitcoin has risen more than 16% so far this year. The crypto market has started heating up in the past few months, thanks to improving macroeconomic conditions and in anticipation of rate cuts by the US Fed. Crypto trading platform CoinSwitch saw a 200% sequential growth in trading volumes in Q3 2023. Coinbase Global Inc., the largest US crypto exchange, saw net consumer transaction revenue in Q4 2023 rise 60% over a year ago, according to a letter to shareholders.

Although there are positive signs suggesting Bitcoin’s rise, there is scepticism surrounding it due to the unpredictable nature of this asset class. Market participants are looking forward to April now—to see if the halving will drive up Bitcoin prices. **BT**

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